



UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN MINDANAO
Kabacan, Cotabato
Philippines

POLICIES AND GUIDELINES ON GENERATIVE AI USE

AI SHALL BE USED RESPONSIBLY

General Provision

Generative artificial Intelligence (AI, for short) shall be utilized solely as a supportive tool to assist in the research process. It shall not be used as a substitute for intellectual responsibility, nor as the primary author of any part of the research output. ***Students and researchers are therefore expected to possess sufficient subject matter knowledge and expertise to critically evaluate, validate, and take full responsibility for the content of their work.*** Thus, AI-generated content shall not be directly incorporated into the manuscript without undergoing critical evaluation, validation, and substantial revision by the student or researcher. The use of AI must, at all times, uphold the principles of originality, academic integrity, transparency, and accountability.

- **Substantial Human Input** – The research output must demonstrably reflect the student or researcher's own intellectual contribution, including critical analysis, interpretation of data, synthesis of ideas, and articulation of arguments. AI tools may assist in preliminary drafting or structuring; however, the final content must show clear evidence of meaningful human intervention. Outputs that appear to be predominantly AI-generated, with minimal revision or critical engagement by the student, shall be deemed non-compliant with this policy.
- **Verification** – All AI-assisted outputs shall be subject to a verification process. First, the student or researcher is responsible for ensuring the accuracy, reliability, and appropriateness of all AI-generated or AI-assisted content. Second, in the case of theses, the research adviser and the College Research Coordinators (CRC) shall exercise due diligence in reviewing the manuscript to assess the presence, extent, and appropriateness of AI use during defense and approval of the final paper, using institutional forms. This includes validating the correctness of information, checking for potential misinformation or fabricated sources, and ensuring compliance with institutional and ethical standards. Final clearance to proceed shall be contingent upon the satisfaction of both the adviser and the CRC that the work meets the required level of academic integrity.
- **Full Disclosure** – The use of AI tools shall be fully and transparently disclosed by researchers in their research output. For theses, disclosure shall include identifying the specific tools used and manner of which AI was employed through the AI Disclosure Form. Failure to disclose AI use, or any attempt to misrepresent the extent of such use, shall be considered a violation and will be subject to approved sanctions.



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The following are identified responsible and irresponsible use of AI. The definitions are provide on page 16.

Responsible AI-use shall include the following, ***provided*** that verification of generated content is performed:

- Improving paragraph organization and overall tone
- Computer Code generation and correction
- Brainstorming
- Assistance in Interpretation of Data
- Improvement of graphics
- Transcription and Translation
- Idea framing
- Summarization

Irresponsible use of AI shall include:

- Fake references
- Hallucinations/false claims
- Interpretation of raw data (e.g. Data containing personal information)
- Interpretation of Graphs

Policies on the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) **shall not be limited to the foregoing provisions.**

The University of Southern Mindanao reserves the right to interpret, supplement, and enforce these policies in addressing future cases or disputes, including emerging practices that may be identified as either responsible or irresponsible uses of AI.

Such determinations shall be guided by the general provisions of (1) substantial human input, (2) verification, and (3) full disclosure.



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USE OF AI IN RESEARCH PAPERS SHALL BE FULLY DISCLOSED

Transparency - Transparency is one of the key principles of responsible generative AI use. Although current policies on academic honesty cover transparency, there is a need to clarify transparency in the context of generative AI tools. There is currently no universal standard on when and how generative AI use should be disclosed. Therefore, there is a need to set a minimum disclosure standard for the University with the goal of promoting a culture of honesty and transparency in generative AI use. All AI generated content (e.g., texts, images, graphs and etc.) shall be fully disclosed, through the **AI Disclosure Statement Form** (Appendix A)

Disclosure statement must contain:

- The specific generative AI tool/s or services that were used.
- The specific prompt used.
- For images, the caption should indicate that the image was AI-generated using this format: "Generated using [Tool], [Date]" with the prompt

This shall serve as an attachment to the Application for defense (outline & Manuscript) and Approval of Thesis (Outline & Manuscript).

RESPONSIBLE USE OF AI SHALL BE EXPLICITLY STATED

An Academic Integrity Statement (Appendix B) shall be included in the preliminary pages of the thesis, stating:

I hereby declare that the contents of this paper is within the permissive standards of the University of Southern Mindanao and does not in any way, go against institutional policies.

All use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools in this thesis (outline/manuscript) is fully disclosed, clearly specified in the AI disclosure statement, and carefully verified for accuracy. Further, such use is solely to improve word choice, language clarity, grammar and coherence, generating or correcting computer code, brainstorming, idea framing, transcription and translation, assisting in interpretation of data, and/or summarization. AI tools were NOT used to fabricate citations, create fictitious references, generate unsupported claims, misrepresent sources, or interpret datasets containing personal information. All references included in this paper were manually verified and sourced from legitimate academic materials. All cited statements in the manuscript were carefully



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checked to ensure that they are accurately supported by and directly based on the referenced sources.

Furthermore, no part of the work submitted has been made in an unethical and inappropriate manner, whether by plagiarizing, infringing on any third person's copyright, or falsifying data, and that no part of the Manuscript submitted has been used for any other paper in another higher education or research institution.

The statement shall be signed by the student with the date.

ADVISERS SHALL USE AI DETECTOR TOOL (SUCH AS TURN-IT-IN) COUPLED WITH PERSONAL JUDGEMENT (AI CHECKLIST) FOR VALIDITY CHECK

Validation - AI-generated content shall be thoroughly reviewed and validated for accuracy. Coherence, and relevance to ensure that it does not inadvertently copy or reproduce existing copyrighted material without proper attribution. AI generated information shall be cross-checked with reliable sources and academic literature to ensure credibility. Thesis advisers may use AI detector tools to flag suspicious submissions however, such must not be the sole basis for validation. Advisers shall adhere to the Checklist form provided by the university as a guide for their personal judgement on the output and **shall be checked from preliminaries (defense) to approval of paper**. If student claims to not have used AI in their paper but was proven false during defense or evaluation of final paper, the decision will be subject to the decision of the examining committee or the respective DRC and adviser. All AI generated content (e.g., texts, images, graphs and etc.) shall be fully disclosed

- AI detector tool (Turn-it-in results)
- Personal judgement
 - AI Disclosure Statement (see Appendix A)
 - AI Checklist (For defense & paper) (see Appendix C)
- For images, the caption should indicate that the image was AI-generated using this format: "Generated using [Tool], [Date]" with the prompt

Such checklist and disclosure statement will be employed from preliminaries (defense) to appendices of the final paper. Furthermore, we impose the use of



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referencing tools such as Zotero for students, to hasten the process of cross-checking at the DRC level and to avoid the use of fake references in research paper. Such checklist and disclosure statement will be employed from preliminaries

STUDENTS SHOULD USE A DIGITAL RESEARCH OR REFERENCE MANAGER TO BETTER FACILITATE CHECKING.

7.1.k.1 Referencing and Referencing Tools

For references, the University shall use American Psychological Association (APA) (latest edition, 7th ed. as of 2023) style in all student theses and publications, except those in disciplines (mathematics, physics, etc.) where the American Mathematical Society (AMS) style is the norm. In both styles, four elements are included: **author/s, date, title, and source**. It is the author's responsibility to find all these elements in the reference cited, and to maintain the consistency between the in-text citations and the end list of literature cited.

The University encourages the use of a reference manager such as **Zotero** for APA style and of **Latex** for AMS style. These tools can help students present citations in the correct format and ensure that all references cited in the text appear in the reference list.

Type of reference	Example	Zotero Guide
Journal	Junatas, K. & Molina, E. (2021). Anthelmintic resistance of gastrointestinal nematodes of albedondule, levanisole and isemedin in Murrah buffaloes. <i>Journal of Agricultural Research, Development, Extension and Technology</i> , 3(1), 55-59.	If a DOI exists, click "Add Items by Identifier" and type/paste the DOI. This will automatically fill in all relevant fields. If no DOI exists: - Add "Journal Article" Enter information for: - Title of article: Use capital letter only for the first letter of the first word - Journal title: Use capital letter for all the first letters of all major words - Date: year only - Volume: - Issue: - Page numbers

Figure 3. Policy on referencing tools as per RDE manual

Analysis of microbiota in cultures of the green microalga *Tetraselmis suecica*

Animal salmonellosis: A brief review of "host adaptation and host specificity"

Antibacterial activity from marine microalgae in laboratory culture

Antifungal Activities of *Chlorella vulgaris* and *Chlorella minutissima* Microalgae

Antimicrobial activities of microalgae: An invited review

Antimicrobial activities of microalgae: An invited review

Antimicrobial resistance in *Salmonella* isolates from

Antioxidants from macroalgae: potential application

Antioxidants from macroalgae: potential application

Artificial Intelligence in Education: A Panoramic Review

Artificial Intelligence-Enabled Intelligent Assistant

Biofilm development capacity of *Salmonella* strain

View Online

Add Note

Add Attachment

Find Available PDF

Export to CSV

Export to BibTeX

Export to RIS

Export to EndNote

Export to RefWorks

Export to Mendeley

Export to Zotero

Export to Jupyter

Export to LaTeX

Export to Markdown

Export to HTML

Export to PDF

Export to EPUB

Export to MOBI

Export to DJVU

Export to XPS

Export to SVG

Export to EPS

Export to AI

Export to PSD

Export to RAW

Export to TIFF

Export to DNG

Export to CR2

Export to CR3

Export to NEF

Export to ARW

Export to RW2

Export to ORF

Export to PEF

Export to X3F

Export to K25

Export to M27

Export to SRF

Export to HEIF

Export to HEIC

Export to AVIF

Export to GIF

Export to PNG

Export to JPEG

Export to J2K

Export to JPE

Export to JFIF

Export to JP2

Export to JPI

Export to JPM

Export to JPM2

Export to JPM3

Export to JPM4

Export to JPM5

Export to JPM6

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Export to JPM100

Figure 4. References will be exported as CSV file and will be used as an attachment for AI disclosure.



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Zotero is a free, open-source research management tool that helps you collect, organize, annotate, cite, and share research sources. It is already included in the RDE Manual (Figure 3). It operates as a desktop application with browser extensions, enabling one-click saving of citations and PDFs from web pages, databases, and library catalogs. It automates bibliography creation in over 9,000 styles. ***Students will be required to attach a list of references generated by a digital research tool such as Zotero (Figure 4)*** in their thesis, to ensure that the final thesis contains no fake references and to help demonstrate that students have gone through all the references that they cited.

THERE SHALL BE CONSEQUENCES FOR REPEATED VIOLATIONS ON RESPONSIBLE AI USE

There shall be sanctions for non-compliance on responsible AI use (**see flowcharts on the next pages**). The examining committee shall use the checklist for responsible AI use. During defense when the thesis is subjected to the AI checklist and traces of irresponsible use of AI is found, the student will only be subject to re-defense. After defense, the students shall adhere to the revisions

After the student has revised and addressed comments during defense, the student may proceed to the 1st checking for the approval of the thesis. If disapproved after 1st checking due to apparent irresponsible AI use, no sanctions will be imposed yet and the student shall strictly adhere to the revisions.

After the student has revised, they may proceed to the 2nd checking for the approval of the thesis. If traces of irresponsible AI use is still apparent in the paper during 2nd checking, the student shall be sanctioned under the provisions of Article 257 (Sanctions) of the Student Code.

1st offense (violations found during 2nd checking): Suspension for thirty (30) days to one semester.

2nd offense (violations found during 3rd checking): Suspension for one (1) semester to one year.

3rd Offense (violations found during 4th checking): Expulsion from the university.



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DEFINITION OF TERMS

Generative AI- Generative AI is a type of artificial intelligence tool that is able to generate images, text, videos, and other media in response to inputted prompts from a user. Examples of generative AI are ChatGPT, Gemini, DALL-E, and Jenni AI, and etc.

Allowable AI use, *provided that the user verifies the accuracy of the generated content*:

Improving word choice and sentence structure- Selecting words to accurately convey ones ideas or intended message in clear and suitable language.

Improving paragraph organization and overall tone- Restructuring paragraphs for better coherence and persuasiveness.

Computer Code generation and correction- Creating and refining programming code to ensure its accuracy, functionality, and efficiency.

Brainstorming- Generating and exploring ideas for conceptualization and direction.

Assistance in Interpretation of Data- Using AI as a supportive tool to analyze and explain research findings, provided that no identifiable or sensitive data are disclosed or shared online.

Improvement of Graphics- Generation of graphs, enhancement of images or any media related AI use provided that full disclosure (AI tool, Prompt, and Date) is provided in the caption.

Transcription & Translation- Conversion of spoken or written content into text or another language using AI tools, with proper verification by the student to ensure fidelity, context preservation, and academic integrity.

Idea framing- Using AI as a supportive tool to organize and structure original ideas.

Summarization- Condensing or restating content, provided that the user verifies the accuracy, completeness, and contextual integrity of the summarized output before use or submission.



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Non-permissible/irresponsible use of AI

Fake references- References that are non-existent, including articles with invalid volumes or page numbers, DOIs that lead to no sources, books that have not been published, and etc.

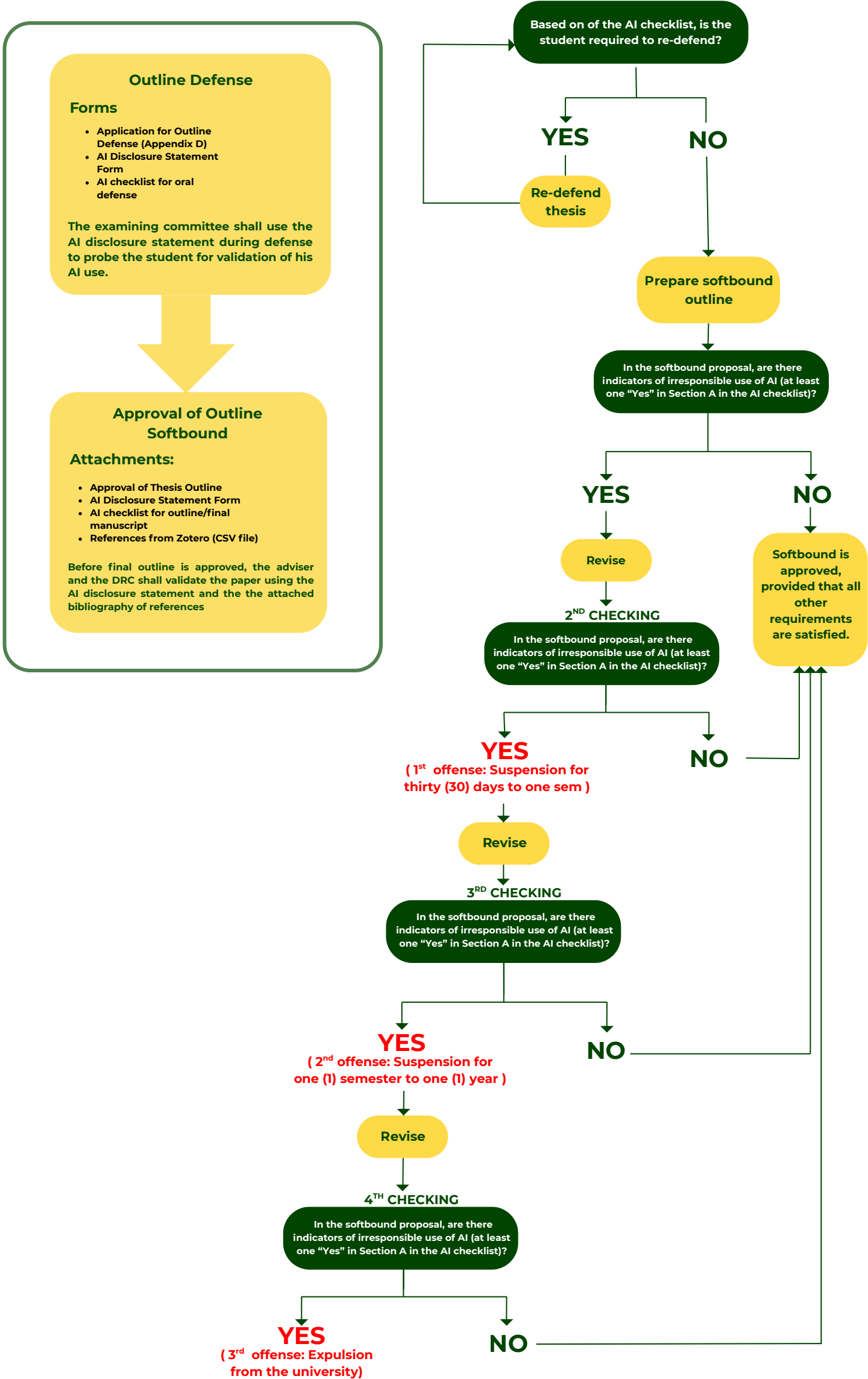
Hallucinations/false claims- Claims that are cited in the paper but cannot be found in the cited journal or source.

Without substantial human input- Generating and incorporating AI content with minimal or no critical thinking, analysis, or meaningful revision resulting in work that does not reflect own intellectual contribution.

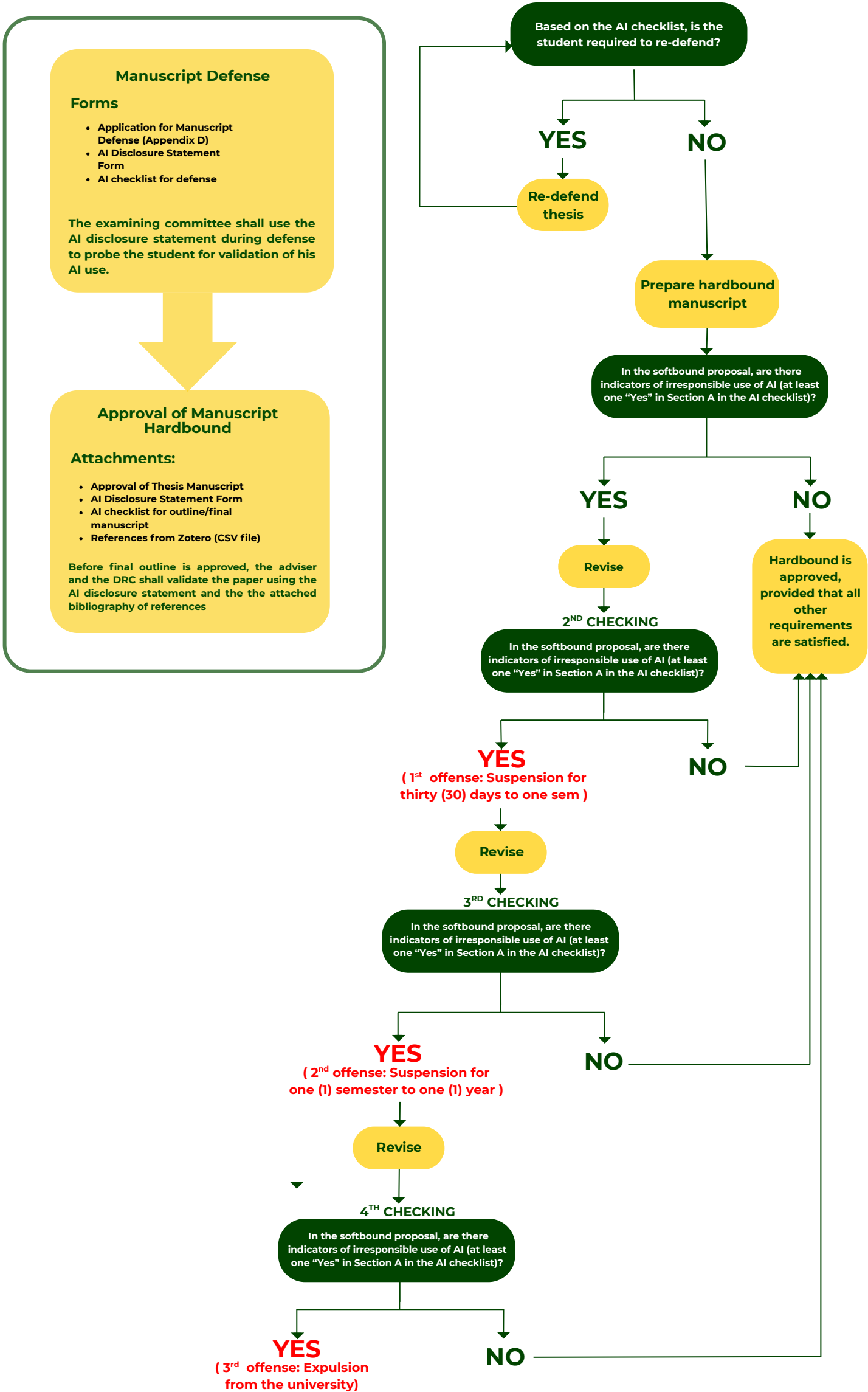
Feeding personal and sensitive information- Feeding data containing personal and sensitive information to the AI tool for interpretation. Personal and sensitive information include all that is provided in RA NO. 10173 or the Data Privacy Act.

Interpretation of Graphs- Full or predominant reliance on AI for analyzing graphs without substantial human interpretation or critical input.

OUTLINE



MANUSCRIPT



	UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN MINDANAO Kabacan, Cotabato Philippines	
AI DISCLOSURE STATEMENT		

This research paper serves as an attachment for:

- ☐ Outline/Manuscript defense
- ☐ Final Outline/Manuscript

This research paper used AI for (Check all that apply):

- | | | |
|--|---|---|
| ☐ Improving word choice and sentence structure | ☐ Improvement of graphics | ☐ Computer code generation or correction |
| ☐ Improving paragraph organization and overall tone | ☐ Assistance in interpretation of data | ☐ Brainstorming |
| ☐ Transcription and/or Translation | ☐ Idea framing | ☐ Summarization |
- ☐ I did not use AI in this paper

The use of AI for this paper is reflected herein.

AI Tool Used: _____ (e.g. OpenAI / Gemini, etc)

Prompts used

AI Tool Used: _____ (e.g. OpenAI / Gemini, etc)

Prompts used

Add more tables if several AI tools were used.

Disclosure of AI Use in Non-Text Media, Including Images, Videos, etc.

Figure number or Location	Prompt Used	Caption
Figure XX ☐	Paste here the prompt entered in the AI to ☐	Paste here the figure caption, which should also disclose AI use as follows: Generated using _____, [date]
Appendix XX		
etc [add more as necessary]		



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AI DISCLOSURE STATEMENT

All AI-assisted outputs were critically reviewed, edited, and validated by the author, adviser, and department research coordinator to ensure accuracy, originality, academic integrity, and compliance with ethical research practices. The author assumes full responsibility for the content and integrity of this paper.

Printed name and signature of student/s

APPROVED:

Adviser

Date

Department Research Coordinator

Date

	UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN MINDANAO Kabacan, Cotabato Philippines	
AI CHECKLIST		

Thesis title: _____ Date: _____

Name of student/s: _____

For Outline/Manuscript Defense

☐ Defense
 ☐ 1st re-defense
 ☐ 2nd re-defense

	Yes	No
The student can explain complex passages from the thesis in simpler terms when asked by the panel. For example, the student can answer questions such as: How can you explain this paragraph of the thesis?		
The student can justify the sources, citations, or theoretical concepts used in the literature review. For example, the student can answer questions such as: - What is the main argument of this cited study? - How or what part of this cited study is relevant in your research?		
(For manuscript defense only) The student can clearly explain how the data were analyzed. Sample question: For example, the student can answer questions such as: ☐ How did you analyze your data?		
All cited references are existing (i.e., There are no fake references).		
All information presented in the thesis is accurate, and assertions supported by references are true to the cited sources.		

- ☐ (At least one "no") The student has to re-defend.
☐ The student has demonstrated knowledge of all claims and may proceed to be evaluated on other aspects of the paper.

Approved:

_____ Adviser	_____ College Research Coordinator
Date	Date

For Approval of Outline/Manuscript

☐ 1st checking
 ☐ 2nd checking
 ☐ 3rd checking
 ☐ 4th checking

INDICATORS OF IRRESPONSIBLE USE OF AI	Yes	No
A. Sanctionable AI use		
A1. The thesis contains fake citations or references.		
A2. The thesis contains hallucinations, fake data, unsupported claims, and/or claims that are not true to the cited sources.		
B. According to Prompts		
B1. Portions of the thesis were generated by AI, without substantial human input.		
B2. AI was used as the sole tool for analyzing the results		
B3. Personal information was fed into the system.		
B4. References were summarized using AI, with little indication that the student actually read the original source.		
B5. The thesis contains fake citations or references.		

- ☐ (At least one "Yes" in section A) Thesis contains sanctionable use of AI, and must be revised.
 (Note: If instances of **A1** and/or **A2** persist after the first revision, students will be subject to approved sanctions.)
☐ (At least one "Yes" in section B) Thesis contains irresponsible use of AI, and must be revised.
☐ Thesis is found to be compliant with responsible use of AI.

Approved:

_____ Adviser	_____ College Research Coordinator
Date	Date



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ACADEMIC INTEGRITY STATEMENT

I hereby declare that the contents of this paper is within the permissive standards of the University of Southern Mindanao and does not in any way, go against institutional policies.

All use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools in this thesis (outline/manuscript) is fully disclosed, clearly specified in the AI disclosure statement, and carefully verified for accuracy. Further, such use is solely to improve word choice, language clarity, grammar and coherence, generating or correcting computer code, brainstorming, idea framing, transcription and translation, assisting in interpretation of data, and/or summarization. AI tools were NOT used to fabricate citations, create fictitious references, generate unsupported claims, misrepresent sources, or interpret datasets containing personal information. All references included in this paper were manually verified and sourced from legitimate academic materials. All cited statements in the manuscript were carefully checked to ensure that they are accurately supported by and directly based on the referenced sources.

Furthermore, no part of the work submitted has been made in an unethical and inappropriate manner, whether by plagiarizing, infringing on any third person's copyright, or falsifying data, and that no part of the Manuscript submitted has been used for any other paper in another higher education or research institution.

Student

Date